

Business

1. Hyundai is on track to outsell Ford in the US this quarter, according to Cox analysts — a remarkable shift for a brand many Americans once dismissed as budget. What is the main reason Ford is losing ground?
 - a. Ford recalled its best-selling truck line over a safety defect
 - b. Ford lacks competitive hybrid models while Hyundai has several
 - c. Ford raised prices sharply after a new union pay deal
2. The Laughing Cow has been grinning from cheese packets since 1921. But the brand recently rolled out special US packaging featuring something very different from its famous cheerful mascot. What did they change?
 - a. The cow was replaced with a goat to reflect a new recipe
 - b. The cow was given a sad, somber expression instead of its usual smile
 - c. The cow was removed entirely and replaced with a minimalist logo
3. McDonald's is pivoting its global strategy to chase a bigger slice of the fried chicken market, as health worries around beef and rising meat prices shift what people order. What specific target has McDonald's set itself?
 - a. To double its chicken menu items in every market within two years
 - b. To gain an extra 1.5 percentage points of global chicken market share
 - c. To make chicken its highest-revenue category by 2027
4. EU electric car registrations jumped by nearly 63% in August compared to the same month last year. Record fuel prices helped, but not every carmaker benefited equally. Which group of manufacturers is struggling despite the EV boom?
 - a. Scandinavian carmakers, hit by supply chain shortages
 - b. German carmakers, who are failing to keep pace with the broader market recovery
 - c. French carmakers, penalised by new EU emissions rules

Economics

5. The OECD (a club of mostly wealthy nations that tracks global economic health) recently raised its forecast for world economic growth in 2026 to 2.9%. Despite one major new disruption, the global economy has held up better than expected. What is that disruption?
 - a. A wave of bank failures in emerging markets
 - b. The energy shock caused by the Iran war
 - c. A collapse in global semiconductor supply
6. Record petrol and diesel prices are squeezing European households, and several EU governments have recently responded with emergency measures. France, Germany and Spain are among those acting. Which of these is NOT one of the tools they are using?
 - a. Cutting fuel taxes
 - b. Introducing rationing limits on how much fuel households can buy
 - c. Offering direct subsidies to help consumers with fuel costs
7. Ahead of a recent Trump–Xi summit in Washington, the White House published a list of 40 countries accused of transshipping Chinese goods — that is, routing products through a third country to avoid US tariffs (import taxes). How many of those 40 countries were in Latin America?
 - a. Three
 - b. Nine
 - c. Fourteen
8. Norway is often held up as a global leader in electric vehicle adoption, but the latest figures are more striking than most people realise. Roughly what share of new cars registered in Norway are electric?
 - a. Around 60%
 - b. Around 80%
 - c. More than 95%

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal that sits at the heart of almost every electric vehicle battery and smartphone?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Australia
 - c. Argentina
10. Which economist gave us the term 'creative destruction' — the idea that capitalism advances by constantly wiping out old industries and replacing them with new ones?
 - a. John Maynard Keynes
 - b. Joseph Schumpeter
 - c. Friedrich Hayek

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1. Hyundai is on track to outsell Ford in the US this quarter, according to Cox analysts — a remarkable shift for a brand many Americans once dismissed as budget. What is the main reason Ford is losing ground?

b. Ford is losing ground because it has very few hybrid vehicles to offer. Cox analysts point to Hyundai's strong hybrid lineup as the key driver of its gains, while Ford and GM have been slow to fill that gap. Hybrids (cars with both a petrol engine and an electric motor) have surged in popularity as buyers who are not ready to go fully electric still want better fuel economy.

2. The Laughing Cow has been grinning from cheese packets since 1921. But the brand recently rolled out special US packaging featuring something very different from its famous cheerful mascot. What did they change?

b. The Laughing Cow temporarily swapped its iconic grin for a glum, somber expression as part of a US marketing campaign. It is a classic 'sad marketing' stunt — brands occasionally lean into irony or unexpected emotion to get people talking. At 105 years old, the Laughing Cow's smile is one of the most recognisable faces in the dairy aisle, which is exactly what makes ditching it so attention-grabbing.

3. McDonald's is pivoting its global strategy to chase a bigger slice of the fried chicken market, as health worries around beef and rising meat prices shift what people order. What specific target has McDonald's set itself?

b. McDonald's has said it wants to take an extra 1.5 percentage points of the global chicken market — a modest-sounding figure that translates into enormous revenue at McDonald's scale. The move puts it in direct competition with KFC and a wave of specialist chicken chains that have become especially popular with younger diners. Chicken has quietly overtaken beef as the world's most consumed meat.

4. EU electric car registrations jumped by nearly 63% in August compared to the same month last year. Record fuel prices helped, but not every carmaker benefited equally. Which group of manufacturers is struggling despite the EV boom?

b. German carmakers — including Volkswagen, BMW and Mercedes — are struggling to capitalise on the surge in EV demand across the EU. While overall registrations jumped nearly two-thirds year-on-year, the gains are being captured disproportionately by others, including Chinese brands expanding into Europe. It is a striking reversal for an industry that once defined European automotive ambition.

Economics

5. The OECD (a club of mostly wealthy nations that tracks global economic health) recently raised its forecast for world economic growth in 2026 to 2.9%. Despite one major new disruption, the global economy has held up better than expected. What is that disruption?

b. The OECD nudged up its 2026 global growth forecast to 2.9%, saying the world economy absorbed the energy shock from the Iran war better than feared. However, the OECD flagged that persistent inflation (a sustained rise in prices), rising bond yields (the interest rate governments pay to borrow money), and the risk of a longer conflict still cloud the outlook. Growth of 2.9% is below the pre-pandemic average of around 3.5%.

6. Record petrol and diesel prices are squeezing European households, and several EU governments have recently responded with emergency measures. France, Germany and Spain are among those acting. Which of these is NOT one of the tools they are using?

b. Fuel rationing has not been part of the EU response. Governments have instead focused on cutting fuel taxes (reducing the amount added to the pump price by the state) and offering subsidies (direct financial support to consumers or businesses). Rationing — capping how much fuel individuals can purchase — is a far more intrusive intervention, last seen in Western Europe during the 1970s oil crisis.

7. Ahead of a recent Trump–Xi summit in Washington, the White House published a list of 40 countries accused of transshipping Chinese goods — that is, routing products through a third country to avoid US tariffs (import taxes). How many of those 40 countries were in Latin America?

b. Nine Latin American countries were among the 40 flagged by the White House for transshipping Chinese goods. Transshipping is when products are exported from China to a third country, relabelled or lightly processed, and then re-exported to the US as if they originated there — allowing them to dodge tariffs aimed at Chinese imports. The practice has grown sharply since US-China trade tensions escalated after 2018.

8. Norway is often held up as a global leader in electric vehicle adoption, but the latest figures are more striking than most people realise. Roughly what share of new cars registered in Norway are electric?

c. More than 95% of new car registrations in Norway are electric — the highest share of any country in the world. Norway got there through decades of generous tax breaks and subsidies for EVs rather than any single dramatic policy shift. Perhaps equally surprising: about one in four of those new EVs is from a fully or partly Chinese-owned brand, suggesting Chinese carmakers are winning market share even where consumers are highly environmentally conscious.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal that sits at the heart of almost every electric vehicle battery and smartphone?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer, accounting for roughly half of global output, mostly from hard-rock mines in Western Australia. Chile holds the largest known reserves (mostly in salt flats) and is the second-biggest producer. Together with Argentina and China, these four countries control the vast majority of global lithium supply — a fact that makes them strategically important as EV demand surges.

10. Which economist gave us the term 'creative destruction' — the idea that capitalism advances by constantly wiping out old industries and replacing them with new ones?

b. Joseph Schumpeter, an Austrian economist writing in the early twentieth century, coined 'creative destruction' to describe how innovation kills off existing businesses and jobs while generating new ones. He saw this churn as the engine of capitalist progress, not a flaw in it. The term is now regularly invoked whenever a new technology — from the internet to AI — disrupts an established industry.